



» IPL AUCTION



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When the League chose the unfinished over the established

The IPL 2026 auction revealed a preference for projection over pedigree, as teams invested heavily in uncapped players and showed restraint with experienced but capped names.

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The IPL 2026 auction saw a combined total of Rs. 215.45 crore spent on 77 players by the 10 franchises. Emerging from the exercise was a clear pattern of calculated

signings targeting specific roles, driven by sharp, ground-level scouting

Unsurprisingly, Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) and Chennai Super Kings (CSK) were the busiest teams at the auction, having entered the proceedings with the biggest purses.

Their approaches, however, diverged sharply. While KKR focused on marquee overseas names, CSK

trained its sights firmly on uncapped Indian talent.

Overseas firepower

KKR made three of the six most expensive signings of the IPL 2026 auction: Cameron Green (Rs. 25.20 crore), Matheesha Pathirana (Rs. 18 crore), and Mustafizur Rahman (Rs. 9.20 crore).

Green, expectedly, emerged as